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BREAD

Spicy miso and nori brioche
Served with mentaiko butter with chili powder

AMUSE BOUCHE

Kohada “Nigiri” of kohada sashimi on top of potato salad
finished with pickle gel, mustard seed, horseradish sauce and shaved horseradish
Paired with a glass of fish soup

SOMEN

Japanese cold somen with Hokkaido oyster
served in a tomato dashi with bonito vinegar gel, various algae, tomato, sudachi lime, and junsai

SCALLOP

Pan seared Hokkaido scallop topped with Japan sakura ebi and mentaiko with chili powder
Corn and scallop mousse showered by corn sauce and squid ink sauce

BLACK COD

Modern “saikyoyaki” of Canadian black cod covered with miso sauce
Paired with chanterelle mushrooms, Jerusalem artichoke purée and caramelized cream sauce with miso powder

PIGEON

Confit pigeon leg with chicken skin cracker and black garlic sauce
Pigeon breast with okinawa black sugar and kinome, beetroot, redcurrant jam, and Arima sansho

PINEAPPLE

Trilogy of pineapple, mango, and passionfruit
paired with milk tuile, osmanthus honey jelly, sea buckthorns ravioli

GENMAICHA & CAVIAR

Genmaicha gelato served with oscietra caviar
Kombu oil, Yamecha cream, genmaicha shortbread and crumble, and warabimochi

MADELEINE

Homemade sake madeleine with lemon and lime zest

PETIT FOURS

Dark chocolate with raspberry powder





Nestled inside a building of art galleries, Arbor provides us with a natural panorama of Hong Kong. The elegant interior saturates the space, forming a special gallery on its own. As we settle into a comfortable position on the sofa, the sommelier arrives with a champagne trolley. We are lucky enough to try a glass of Krug 171ème Edition that is not only a newly released edition but also a brand new bottle. With a noble sigh of the cork, we are honored to share the privilege to take the very first sip of this exquisite bottle of Krug.

As I indulge in the rich brioche aroma of Krug, a real brioche dough is presented to us. Made with spicy miso and nori, and served with mentaiko butter and chili powder, this brioche exudes a captivating Japanese temperament. It reads both soft yet punching on the palate, thanks to the gentle spiciness. While the use of mentaiko and nori in the brioche hints at the Japanese fusion style of the restaurant, the chef reinforces this idea by surprising us with a unique twist, a kohada “nigirizushi” that consists of potato salad instead of vinegar rice. A signature dish with brilliant innovation, this kohada amuse bouche is truly a marvelous dish. The fishy taste of the kohada is beautifully complemented by the creaminess of the potato salad, while the salad is light in a way that allows the umami flavors to shine through. The mustard seeds and horseradish components serve as a delightful substitute for wasabi, and the pickle gel offers a modern take on the vinegar traditionally used in kohada nigiri.







While the amuse bouche represents a Scandinavian-Japanese fusion creation, the next dish takes on a predominantly Japanese character. The only trace of Scandinavia is come from the incorporation of algae, a beloved ingredient among the Scandinavian people, rather than the more traditional Japanese dashi seasoning, kombu. This dish features somen noodles accompanied by a generous piece of Hokkaido oyster, served cold in a tomato dashi infused with bonito vinegar gel, assorted algae, tomato, sudachi lime, and junsai.

A seasonal creation that offers a refreshing reprieve from the summer heat, with layers of acidity and diverse layers of textures and oceanic umami. The duo of tomato and sudachi oozes a magic acidic profile that is aromatically complex and flavorfully rich. The algae, in a quite gentle way, underscores the noodle with various mild textures and tastes. The use of Junsai adds a fascinating and rare gel-like texture that harmonizes with the bonito vinegar gel, while also imparting a subtle hint of bitterness. The oyster, a torpedo of oceanic umami, releases a burst of flavors that amplify the dashi's inherent richness with bright fruity undertones and a profound minerality.





With the refreshing somen dish countering the sweltering heat, our palates eagerly anticipate the next course, a seafood course featuring scallop and sakura ebi. Gently seared to perfection, the Hokkaido scallop mingles with sakura ebi in unity, while a dollop of mentaiko echos the mentaiko butter in the brioche serving. In addition to the ocean treasures, the dish celebrates corn with a capricious presence at its core of the concoction. A vibrant expanse of corn sauce is at the center of the stage, almost as if stealing the spotlight from the scallop. Further adorned with a calligraphic stroke of squid ink sauce, the sabayon-like corn sauce showcases a rich creaminess, velvety texture, and mellowly sweet that caresses the tongue. Like a melodious duet, the corn sauce harmonizes naturally with the scallop, creating an exquisite intertwining culinary embrace. Beneath this golden sea of corn, a thin layer of scallop mousse conceals the corn kernels, akin to a delicate ravioli. As we savor each bite, the corn's delightful succulency and crunchiness add a vital texture, complementing the scallop mousse, which delivers a gel-like sensation reminiscent of egg whites.



In a graceful prelude of scallop and corn, the first main dish emerges. Featuring Canadian black cod, the dish whispers a luscious ode to the traditional “tara no Saikyo-yaki” dish of Japan. A celebrated course traditionally served in countless bistros and homes of Japan, the “tara no Saikyo-yaki” dish stars cod, which would be fermented in a sweet miso paste for three to four days before being baked. Here at Arbor, the precious Canadian black cod is honored in a similar manner with a delightful sweet miso glaze. The fish is further paired with chanterelle mushrooms that implies an exquisite earthy yet buttery aroma to the medley that sublimates the mellowness of the miso. Behold the two quenelles of purée that grace each side of the dish akin to yin and yang, a duo of Jerusalem artichoke purée and caramelized cream sauce with miso powder. The Jerusalem artichoke casts a spell of enchantment, captivating every cell of our palate with its sophisticated aroma. A rare dish exhibiting shades of nuances within a slender spectrum, a unity with a thread of consistency lingering in every elements, a true testament to the artistry of subtlety.





How often do you encounter caviar in a dessert? Probably never. While I have come across caviar dishes that draw inspiration from dessert concepts, for instance Eleven Madison Park's caviar New York cheesecake or Atera's pistachio gelato with caviar and IPA foam, it is still a rarity to witness caviar integrated into a main dessert creation. This innovative dessert takes its shape from Japan's beloved gunkan-sushi, a savory delicate. It features a delightful concoction summer favorites from Japan, including Yamecha 「八女茶」 cream from Fukuoka, genmaicha shortbread and crumble, and warabimochi 「蕨餅」. The medley is then topped with a genmaicha ice cream with a touch of kombu oil, all delicately encased within a wakame-tuile. As we delve into this extraordinary dessert, the caviar explodes, erupting with a burst of fresh oceanic salinity that, combined with the subtle essence of the kombu oil, imparts a sensational umami experience that elevates the entire composition.

As we ascend to the pinnacle where bird and fish mingle, our lunch turns into an orchard of sweets. The pineapple, as our first dessert, surprisingly departs from Japanese ingredients. Here, a classical trilogy of summertime tropical fruits, namely mango, pineapple, and passionfruit, lies at the center of the creation. As if to add a whimsical touch, milk tuile and osmanthus honey jelly infuse the composition with an unexpected layer of mellowness. A rather rare sea buckthorns ravioli, amidst the tropical medley, makes its entrance, bestowing the whole with another dimension of bright acidity. The essence of these luscious fruits is celebrated in every delectable bite, and the interplay of textures and flavors create a captivating gustatory experience.





The final joy arrives in the form of two petit fours, a homemade sake madeleine with lemon and lime zest, and a dark chocolate with raspberry powder. While the Madeleine departs from its traditional shell shape, the flavor nonetheless expresses a steadfastly classical temperament. The Japanese wine aroma is so subtle that almost undetectable, but the refreshing creaminess augmented with a zephyr of citrusy hint lingers on the palate like a gentle whisper, leaving a lasting impression. The Madeleine is served in a soft serve cup, adding a thoughtful touch by allowing those unable to finish it to take home as a special keepsake. The mellow nibble of the chocolate, though seemingly simple, envelops the senses with a velvety sweetness. Its lusciousness encases the entire scene, offering a final sweet indulgence that brings the culinary journey to a delightful conclusion.

With a Finnish chef who is exceptionally passionate about Japanese cuisine and a Japanese chef de cuisine dedicated to Nordic food, Arbor creates a gastronomic scene in which Scandinavian and Japanese cuisine seamlessly weaving into each other, giving birth to a unique and captivating “Arborian” language. In an era where countless restaurants play the concept of fusion, most of which turns out to be nothing more than a gimmick, Arbor stands as a truth gem in the culinary world with the true capability to provide marvelous cuisine.

It is worth mentioning that, despite the many delights Arbor has to offer, the service may leave a few blemishes. Regrettably, there were instances where at least three waiters struggled to distinguish between artichoke and sunchoke, also known as Jerusalem artichoke. During the introduction of the cod dish, they erroneously referred to the purée as artichoke, seemingly unaware of the distinctive qualities of sunchoke. Furthermore, they encountered difficulty in identifying the herbs delicately placed atop the succulent pigeon breast. While these hiccups in service marred the overall experience, it is important to recognize that such intricacies can be challenging for even the most discerning of establishments. Arbor's dedication to culinary excellence remains unmarred, and it is their extraordinary cuisine that continues to shine brightly amidst these occasional missteps.

